Legislative Assembly
Province of Alberta

No. 49

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS

Second Session Thirty-First Legislature

Tuesday, April 21, 2026

The Speaker took the Chair at 1:30 p.m.

Speaker's Statement – Equal Suffrage Statutory Law Amendment Act

The Speaker made a statement recognizing the 110th anniversary of the Equal Suffrage Statutory Law Amendment Act receiving Royal Assent.

Members' Statements

MLA Tejada, Hon. Member for Calgary-Klein, made a statement regarding the importance of Canadian unity.

Mrs. Petrovic, Hon. Member for Livingstone-Macleod, made a statement regarding past comments by members of the Alberta New Democratic Party in relation to Canada.

MLA Kayande, Hon. Member for Calgary-Elbow, made a statement regarding the proposed Government Motion 37 with respect to electoral boundaries.

Mr. Cyr, Hon. Member for Bonnyville-Cold Lake-St. Paul, made a statement regarding the federal government's plan to protect 30 per cent of land and water by 2030.

Ms Goehring, Hon. Member for Edmonton-Castle Downs, made a statement regarding Government policies affecting tourism affordability within the province.

Mr. Dach, Hon. Member for Edmonton-McClung, made a statement regarding the concerns of some Albertans in relation to the Government's planned twinning of highway 3.

Tabling Returns and Reports

Mr. Dach, Hon. Member for Edmonton-McClung:

> CBC News website article dated April 21, 2026, entitled "Alberta premier denies claims of UCP interference on electoral boundaries"
>
> Sessional Paper 476/2025-26

MLA Eremenko, Hon. Member for Calgary-Currie:

> Letter dated April 10, 2026, from Katarina Bogosavljević, PhD, and Elaine Hyshka, PhD, to all Members of the Legislative Assembly, expressing concern regarding possible conflicts of interest in a recent report on the closure of supervised consumption services, relating to comments made by MLA Eremenko during Oral Question Period on April 21, 2026
>
> Sessional Paper 477/2025-26

Hon. Mr. Amery, Minister of Justice:

> Letter dated January 6, 2025, from Tina Trigg, President, Inclusion Alberta, and Trish Bowman, CEO, Inclusion Alberta, to Hon. Mr. Amery, expressing support for the Government's commitment to stopping the expansion of medical assistance in dying
>
> Sessional Paper 478/2025-26

Tablings to the Clerk

Clerk of the Assembly on behalf of Hon. Min. LaGrange, Minister of Primary and Preventative Health Services, pursuant to the Health Quality Council of Alberta Act, cH-7.2, s24(2):

> Health Quality Alberta 2024-25 Annual Report
>
> Sessional Paper 479/2025-26

ORDERS OF THE DAY

Government Motions

37. Moved by Hon. Mr. Schow:

A. Be it resolved that the Legislative Assembly recognize that

(a) the Alberta Electoral Boundaries Commission's Final Report, which was tabled by the Speaker of the Legislative Assembly on March 26, 2026 (Sessional Paper 436/2025-26), makes recommendations to the Legislative Assembly as to the area, boundaries, and names of the electoral divisions of Alberta, referred to as the Final Report,

(b) on the tabling of the Final Report, the Commission appointed under section 2 of the Electoral Boundaries Commission Act is concluded,

(c) the Final Report includes input from Albertans provided through written proposals and public hearings held across Alberta,

(d) the Final Report includes a Majority Report, an Addendum to the Majority Report and a Minority Report,

(e) the Majority Report notes that since the last Electoral Boundaries Commission report in 2017, the population of Alberta has increased by over 800,000 people and that in responding to these changes, the Legislature expanded the number of available seats by two, from 87 to 89,

(f) the Majority Report notes that the size of the Legislative Assembly was only increased by 2 percent despite the population increasing by 20 percent,

(g) the Majority Report expresses regret that the Commission had to remove two ridings from central and north central Alberta in order to address this population increase,

(h) the Majority Report states that the majority of the Commission believes that it would have been able to provide Albertans with more effective representation had the Legislature provided an additional two seats and indicates that, had the Commission been given the power to do so, it may have proposed a map of at least 91 electoral divisions,

(i) the Addendum to the Majority Report

(i) proposes that if the Legislative Assembly cannot concur in the Majority Report's recommendation to remove two electoral divisions from areas outside of the Cities of Edmonton and Calgary, the Legislative Assembly consider amending the Electoral Divisions Act for the purpose of increasing the number of electoral divisions for the next general election from 89 to 91,

(ii) proposes that the matter be referred to an all-party Select Special Committee or other legislative committee, and

(iii) in its four additional recommendations cited as Recommendation 5(a) to (d), provides recommendations to protect certain proposed electoral divisions described in the Majority Report from substantive alteration stemming from the addition of two additional electoral divisions, and

(j) section 3 of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms guarantees that every citizen of Canada has the right to vote in an election of members of the House of Commons or of a legislative assembly and to be qualified for membership therein, which includes a right to effective representation;

B. And be it further resolved that the Legislative Assembly urge the Government to introduce a Bill to amend section 13 of the Electoral Boundaries Commission Act to provide for 91 proposed electoral divisions;

C. And be it furthered resolved that

(a) a Select Special Committee on Electoral Boundaries be established to oversee an independent review of electoral boundaries of Alberta

(i) on an expedited basis, and

(ii) without a requirement to direct the holding of public hearings,

(b) the Committee consists of the following:

(i) Mr. Lunty as the Chair of the Committee;

(ii) 3 Members of the Government caucus nominated by the Government House Leader, the nominations of which are to be submitted to the Chair;

(iii) 2 Members of the Opposition caucus nominated by the Opposition House Leader, the nominations of which are to be submitted to the Chair,

(c) the Committee is constituted on the nomination of a majority of its Members and continues despite any vacancies in its membership,

(d) the Committee be directed to engage independent advisors

(i) to serve on an independent advisory panel to carry out the mandate referred to in clause (e), and

(ii) who are to be appointed by the Committee as follows:

(A) a chair of the independent advisory panel who must be one of the following.

(I) the president of a post-secondary educational institution in Alberta;

(II) a judge or retired judge of any court of Alberta;

(III) a person whose stature and qualifications are similar to those of the persons referred to in subparagraphs (I) and (II);

(B) on nomination of the Leader of His Majesty's Loyal Opposition in consultation with the leaders of other opposition parties represented in the Legislative Assembly, 2 persons who are not Members of the Legislative Assembly;

(C) on nomination of the President of the Executive Council, 2 persons who are not Members of the Legislative Assembly;

(D) with respect to the persons appointed under paragraph (B), one must be a resident in a city and the other resident outside a city at the time of their appointment;

(E) with respect to the persons appointed under paragraph (C), one must be a resident in a city and the other resident outside a city at the time of their appointment;

(F) all persons appointed under paragraphs (A), (B) and (C) must be Canadian citizens, residents of Alberta and at least 18 years of age.

(e) the independent advisory panel's mandate is to

(i) conduct a review of the electoral boundaries of Alberta and make proposals as to the area, boundaries and names of the electoral divisions of Alberta.

(ii) in conducting its review,

(A) divide the electoral boundaries of Alberta into 91 proposed electoral divisions

(B) incorporate the recommendations provided in Recommendation 5 in the Addendum to the Majority Report subject to any modifications the independent advisory panel considers necessary, taking into consideration the requirement for effective representation as guaranteed by the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms and

(I) sparsity, density and rate of growth of the population

(II) communities of interest, including municipalities, regional and rural communities, Indian reserves and Metis settlements,

(III) geographical features,

(IV) the availability and means of communication and transportation between various parts of Alberta,

(V) the desirability of understandable and clear boundaries, and

(VI) any other factors the independent advisory panel considers appropriate, and

(C) ensure that its proposals comply with the following requirements:

(I) the population of a proposed electoral division must not be more than 25 percent above nor more than 25 percent below the average population of all the proposed electoral divisions;

(II) despite subparagraph (I), in the case of no more than 4 of the proposed electoral divisions, if the independent advisory panel is of the opinion that at least 3 of the following criteria exist in a proposed electoral division, the proposed electoral division may have a population that is as much as 50 percent below the average population of all the proposed electoral divisions:

1. the area of the proposed electoral division exceeds 20,000 square kilometres or the total surveyed area of the proposed electoral division exceeds 15,000 square kilometres;

2. the distance from the Legislature Building in Edmonton to the nearest boundary of the proposed electoral division by the most direct highway route is more than 150 kilometres;

3. there is no town in the proposed electoral division that has a population exceeding 8,000 people;

4. the area of the proposed electoral division contains an Indian reserve or a Metis settlement;

5. the proposed electoral division has a portion of its boundary coterminous with a boundary of the Province of Alberta;

(III) for the purpose of the 3rd criterion set out in subparagraph (II), the municipality of Crowsnest Pass is not a town,

(iii) conduct its review despite any vacancies in its membership,

(iv) on or before October 22, 2026, submit to the Committee a report based on its review, and

(v) on the independent advisory panel submitting its report to the Committee, the independent advisory panel's mandate is concluded,

(f) for the purposes of the independent advisory panel carrying out its mandate, the Committee may, at the request of and on behalf of the independent advisory panel, do any of the following:

(i) request access to and the use of any information and statistics that the independent advisory panel considers relevant to its mandate, including any information and statistics gathered and input received by the Electoral Boundaries Commission most recently appointed under the Electoral Boundaries Commission Act, and any records held by the Legislative Assembly Office;

(ii) request advice, information and assistance from the Office of the Chief Electoral Officer;

(iii) request any person to provide the independent advisory panel with advice that the independent advisory panel considers advisable or necessary;

(iv) direct the Legislative Assembly Office to provide administrative support to the independent advisory panel as required,

(g) the Committee be authorized to pay the following:

(i) remuneration, and travelling and living expenses, of the independent advisors as it relates to carrying out the independent advisory panel's mandate;

(ii) reasonable disbursements incurred by the independent advisory panel for the effective conduct of its responsibilities,

(h) if the independent advisory panel submits more than one report to the Committee, the report of a majority of the members of the independent advisory panel is the report of the independent advisory panel, but if there is no majority, the report of the chair is the report of the independent advisory panel,

(i) as soon as practicable after receiving the independent advisory panel's report the Committee

(i) may convene to review the report, including making observations in respect of the report, and

(ii) on conclusion of its review, if any, must submit the report to the Legislative Assembly no later than November 2, 2026,

(j) the Committee continues despite a prorogation of a session and may, without leave of the Legislative Assembly, meet during a period when the Legislative Assembly is adjourned or prorogued, and

(k) on the Committee submitting the report to the Legislative Assembly, the Committee's mandate is concluded.

A debate followed.

Mr. Yao moved adjournment of the debate, which was agreed to.

39. Oral notice having been given April 20, 2026, moved by Hon. Mr. Schow:

> Be it resolved that when further consideration of Government Motion 37 is resumed, not more than one hour shall be allotted to the further consideration of the motion, and upon the expiry of the time allotted, every question necessary for the disposal of the motion shall be put forthwith.

Pursuant to Standing Order 21(7), a debate followed on the programming motion.

The question being put, the motion was agreed to on the voice vote. With Hon. Mr. McIver in the Chair, the names being called for were taken as follows:

For the motion: 46

Amery	LaGrange	Schow
Armstrong-Homeniuk	Loewen	Schulz
Boitchenko	Long	Sigurdson (Highwood)
Bouchard	Lovely	Sinclair
Cyr	Lunty	Singh
Dreeshen	McDougall	Smith
Dyck	Nally	Stephan
Ellis	Neudorf	Turton
Fir	Nicolaides	van Dijken
Getson	Nixon	Wiebe
Glubish	Petrovic	Williams
Horner	Pitt	Wilson
Hunter	Rowswell	Wright (Cypress-Medicine Hat)
Jean	Sawhney	Yao
Johnson	Sawyer	Yaseen
Jones		

Against the motion: 35

Al-Guneid	Elmeligi	Metz
Arcand-Paul	Eremenko	Miyashiro
Batten	Ganley	Nenshi
Boparai	Goehring	Pancholi
Brar (Calgary-North East)	Gray	Renaud
Brar (Edmonton-Ellerslie)	Haji	Sabir
Ceci	Hayter	Schmidt
Chapman	Hoffman	Shepherd
Dach	Ip	Sweet
Deol	Irwin	Tejada
Eggen	Kasawski	Wright (Edmonton-Beverly-Clareview)
Ellingson	Kayande	

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(I) the president of a post-secondary educational institution in Alberta;

(II) a judge or retired judge of any court of Alberta;

(III) a person whose stature and qualifications are similar to those of the persons referred to in subparagraphs (I) and (II);

(B) on nomination of the Leader of His Majesty's Loyal Opposition in consultation with the leaders of other opposition parties represented in the Legislative Assembly, 2 persons who are not Members of the Legislative Assembly;

(C) on nomination of the President of the Executive Council, 2 persons who are not Members of the Legislative Assembly;

(D) with respect to the persons appointed under paragraph (B), one must be a resident in a city and the other resident outside a city at the time of their appointment;

(E) with respect to the persons appointed under paragraph (C), one must be a resident in a city and the other resident outside a city at the time of their appointment;

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1. the area of the proposed electoral division exceeds 20,000 square kilometres or the total surveyed area of the proposed electoral division exceeds 15,000 square kilometres;

2. the distance from the Legislature Building in Edmonton to the nearest boundary of the proposed electoral division by the most direct highway route is more than 150 kilometres;

3. there is no town in the proposed electoral division that has a population exceeding 8,000 people;

4. the area of the proposed electoral division contains an Indian reserve or a Metis settlement;

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(III) for the purpose of the 3rd criterion set out in subparagraph (II), the municipality of Crowsnest Pass is not a town,

(iii) conduct its review despite any vacancies in its membership,

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(v) on the independent advisory panel submitting its report to the Committee, the independent advisory panel's mandate is concluded,

(f) for the purposes of the independent advisory panel carrying out its mandate, the Committee may, at the request of and on behalf of the independent advisory panel, do any of the following:

(i) request access to and the use of any information and statistics that the independent advisory panel considers relevant to its mandate, including any information and statistics gathered and input received by the Electoral Boundaries Commission most recently appointed under the Electoral Boundaries Commission Act, and any records held by the Legislative Assembly Office;

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(iv) direct the Legislative Assembly Office to provide administrative support to the independent advisory panel as required,

(g) the Committee be authorized to pay the following:

(i) remuneration, and travelling and living expenses, of the independent advisors as it relates to carrying out the independent advisory panel's mandate;

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(h) if the independent advisory panel submits more than one report to the Committee, the report of a majority of the members of the independent advisory panel is the report of the independent advisory panel, but if there is no majority, the report of the chair is the report of the independent advisory panel,

(i) as soon as practicable after receiving the independent advisory panel's report the Committee

(i) may convene to review the report, including making observations in respect of the report, and

(ii) on conclusion of its review, if any, must submit the report to the Legislative Assembly no later than November 2, 2026,

(j) the Committee continues despite a prorogation of a session and may, without leave of the Legislative Assembly, meet during a period when the Legislative Assembly is adjourned or prorogued, and

(k) on the Committee submitting the report to the Legislative Assembly, the Committee's mandate is concluded.

A debate followed.

Pursuant to Government Motion 39, agreed to on April 21, 2026, and Standing Order 21(8), at 5:54 p.m. the question was immediately put on Government Motion 37, which was agreed to on the voice vote. With Hon. Mr. McIver in the Chair, the names being called for were taken as follows:

For the motion: 44

Amery	Jones	Sawyer
Armstrong-Homeniuk	LaGrange	Schow
Boitchenko	Loewen	Schulz
Bouchard	Long	Sigurdson (Highwood)
Cyr	Lovely	Sinclair
Dreeshen	Lunty	Singh
Dyck	McDougall	Stephan
Ellis	Nally	van Dijken
Fir	Neudorf	Wiebe
Getson	Nicolaides	Williams
Glubish	Nixon	Wilson
Horner	Petrovic	Wright (Cypress-Medicine Hat)
Hunter	Pitt	Yao
Jean	Rowswell	Yaseen
Johnson	Sawhney	

Against the motion: 36

Al-Guneid	Elmeligi	Kayande
Arcand-Paul	Eremenko	Metz
Batten	Ganley	Miyashiro
Boparai	Goehring	Nenshi
Brar (Calgary-North East)	Gray	Pancholi
Brar (Edmonton-Ellerslie)	Guthrie	Renaud
Ceci	Haji	Sabir
Chapman	Hayter	Schmidt
Dach	Hoffman	Shepherd
Deol	Ip	Sweet
Eggen	Irwin	Tejada
Ellingson	Kasawski	Wright (Edmonton-Beverly-Clareview)

Adjournment

Pursuant to Standing Order 4(2), the Assembly adjourned at 6:02 p.m. until Wednesday, April 22, 2026, at 1:30 p.m.

Hon. Ric McIver,
Speaker